HTML Essentials: Hyperlinks, Images & Paths

A quick reference guide for absolute beginners — built for interview prep.



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What is a Hyperlink?

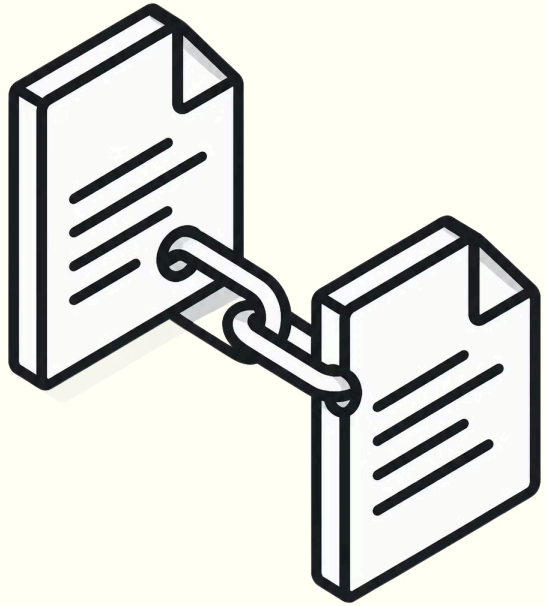
An HTML element that navigates between webpages, files, emails, or page sections. Created with the **<a>** (Anchor) tag.

Basic Syntax

```
<a href="URL">Link Text</a>
```

Key Rule

The `href` attribute holds the destination — without it, the anchor goes nowhere.



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6 Types of Hyperlinks

External

Opens another website

`href="https://..."`

Internal

Links to another page on the same site

`href="about.html"`

Email

Opens the email app

`href="mailto:..."`

Telephone

Calls a number

`href="tel:..."`

Download

Downloads a file

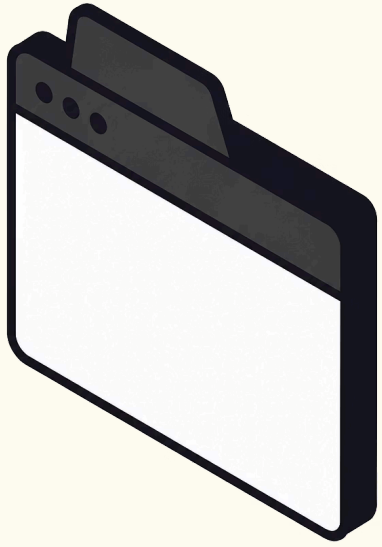
`download attribute`

Bookmark

Jumps to a page section

`href="#id"`

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Target Attribute: Where Links Open

The `target` attribute controls which browsing context receives the linked page.

Value	Behavior
`_self`	Same tab (default)
`_blank`	New tab
`_parent`	Parent frame
`_top`	Full window

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Link Attributes You Should Know



href

Destination URL — **required**. Without it the anchor tag does nothing.



target

Controls where the link opens: `_self`, `_blank`, and more.



title

Tooltip text that appears when hovering over the link.



download

Forces a file download instead of opening it in the browser.

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What is an Image Tag?

HTML uses the `<img>` tag to embed images directly into a webpage. It is a **self-closing tag** — no closing tag is needed.



Basic Syntax

```
<img src="image.jpg" alt="Description">
```

Interview Tip

`src` and `alt` are both essential — interviewers love asking about `alt`'s role in accessibility.

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Essential Image Attributes

1

src

Required. The path or URL to the image file. Without this, nothing renders.

2

alt

Critical for accessibility. Describes the image if it fails to load; read aloud by screen readers.

3

width & height

Set image dimensions in pixels. Prevents layout shift while the page loads.

4

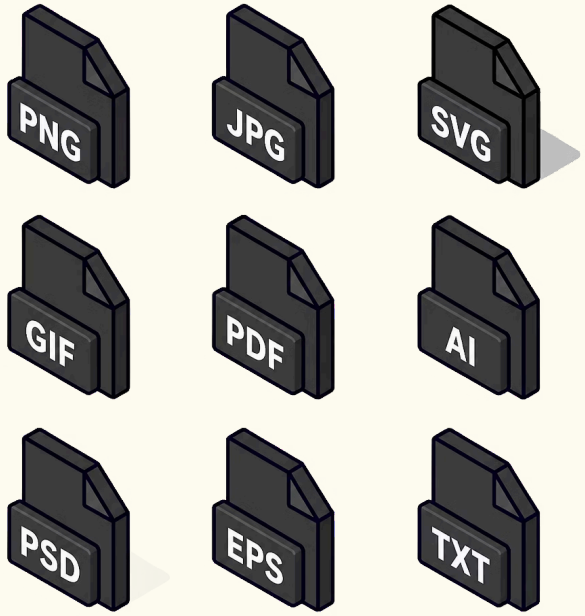
title

Shows a tooltip when the user hovers over the image — optional but useful for UX.

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Image Formats at a Glance

Format	Best Used For
JPG	Photographs & complex images
PNG	Images with transparency
GIF	Simple animations
SVG	Icons & logos (infinitely scalable)
WebP	Modern, optimized for the web



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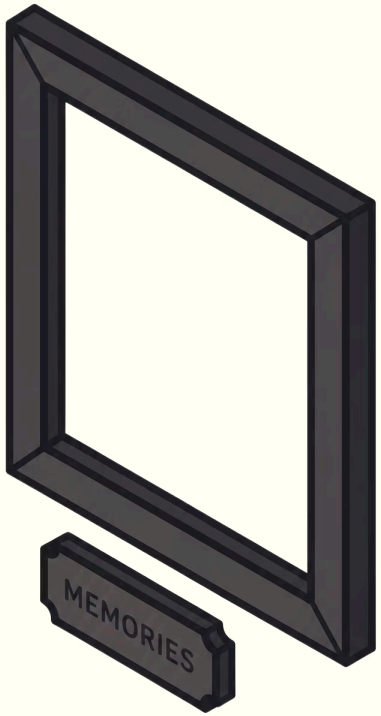


Figure & Figcaption Tags

Use `<figure>` and `<figcaption>` to group an image with its description — this is **semantic HTML**.

<figure>

Groups media (image, chart, diagram) with its caption as a self-contained unit.

<figcaption>

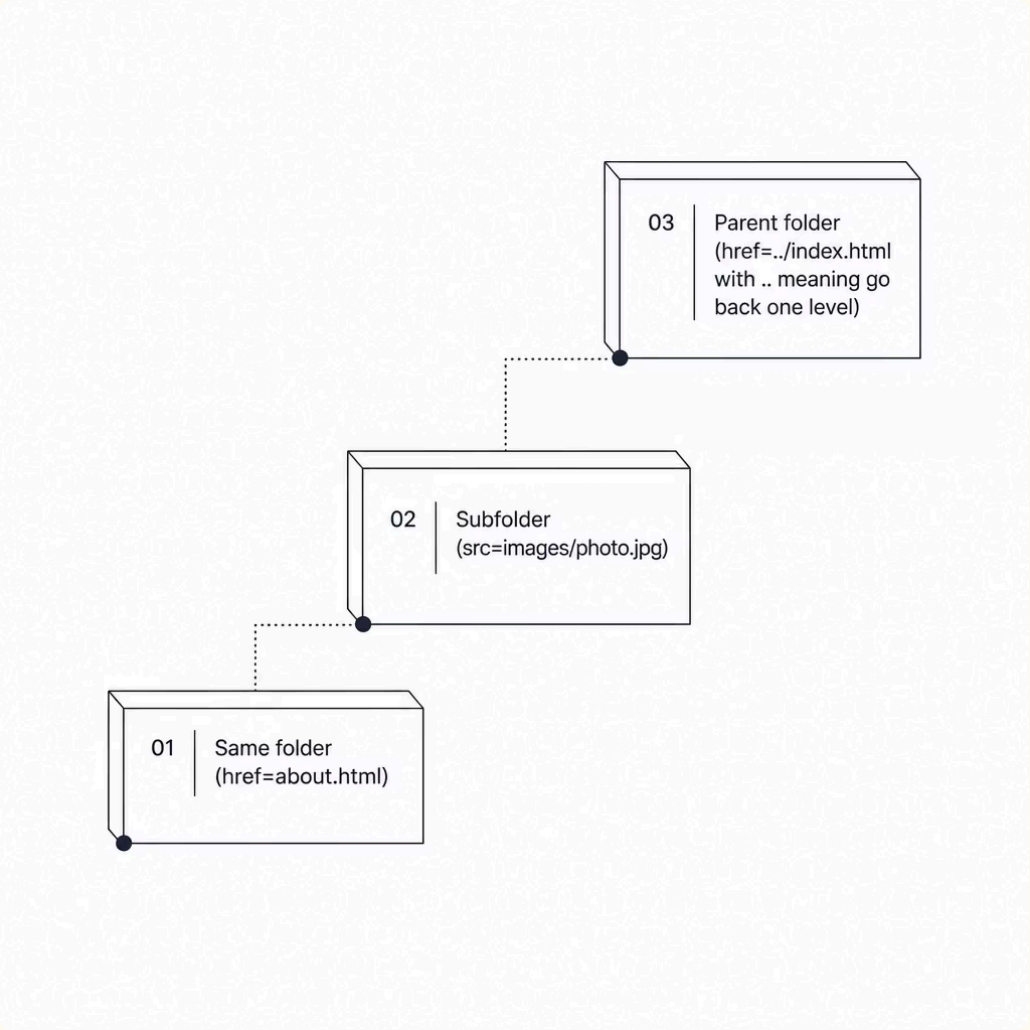
Provides a descriptive text label for the figure — inside the `<figure>` tag.

Why It Matters

Better SEO, better accessibility, and a favourite interview topic on semantic HTML.

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Relative Paths: File Locations



What Is a Relative Path?

A relative path specifies a file's location **relative to the current HTML file** — not from the root of the drive.

- **Same folder:** `<a href="about.html">`
- **Subfolder:** `<img src="images/photo.jpg">`
- **Parent folder:** `<a href="../index.html">`

`..` means "go back one folder level" — memorise this for interviews.

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Absolute Paths: Complete Locations

What Is an Absolute Path?

An absolute path gives the **full URL or file path** to a resource — no ambiguity about location.

- **Example:** `https://example.com/images/photo.jpg`
- **Use for:** External websites and remotely hosted resources
- **Avoid:** Local absolute paths like `C:\Users\...` — they only work on your machine

⚠ Local absolute paths are **not portable** — they break on any other computer. Always prefer relative paths for local files.

Relative vs. Absolute

Type	Portable?	Use When
Relative	✅ Yes	Local files on same site
Absolute (URL)	✅ Yes	External resources
Absolute (local)	❌ No	Never — avoid this

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